

Joachim of Fiore, Apocalyptic Conversion, and the 'Persecuting Society'

Brett Whalen*

University of North Carolina

Abstract

In recent years, scholarship on the 12th-century Christian apocalyptic thinker Joachim of Fiore has highlighted the place of the Jews in his scenarios for the end of the world. Responding in part to R. I. Moore's 1987 work *The Formation of a Persecuting Society*, historians argue that Joachim's vision of a harmonious Jewish apocalyptic conversion stood in contrast with rise of a persecuting mentality among the Christian ruling elite of medieval Europe, who increasingly sought to identify, marginalize, and sometimes violently oppress non-Christian and non-orthodox communities. These scholarly discussions of apocalyptic conversion have extended to include the Western Christian belief that not just the Jews, but also pagans, Muslims, and even non-Western Christians would convert during the earthly Sabbath age that would precede the apocalypse. The resulting field of inquiry into medieval apocalyptic thought promises further insights into the ways that Christian scenarios for the 'end of days' might complicate narratives of religious persecution, violence, and conversion.

For an historical event that has not happened (not yet anyway), the end of the world fascinates scholarly and popular audiences alike. In the captivating realm of speculation about the apocalypse, Joachim of Fiore (d. 1202) numbers among the most creative and controversial of medieval Christian figures. Through his inspired – one might say revolutionary – interpretation of the Bible, Joachim believed that he had discovered a template for understanding the totality of God's plan for history. In his views of the future, he showed particular creativity, imagining the forthcoming age of the Holy Spirit, a time of terrestrial transformation that would bring peace and plenty before the end of history. The fame of the Calabrian abbot, as he is sometimes called, already emerging in his own lifetime, posthumously grew to extraordinary proportions due to the radical tendencies of his less restrained devotees, so-called Joachites, who argued that the era of the Holy Spirit would mean an effective end to the institutional Roman Church.

Starting in earnest with the ground-breaking studies of Herbert Grundmann and Marjorie Reeves, modern scholarship on Joachim of Fiore – formerly seen as a figure on the margins of twelfth-century intellectual life, if not a heretic – has increasingly moved the abbot into the mainstream of medieval historiography.¹ In recent years, scholars have paid particular attention to Joachim's treatment of the Jews and the place of the Jewish faith in God's historical design. Explicitly or implicitly, this focus on the abbot's attitude toward the Jews responds to an ongoing debate about the long twelfth century as a turning point for the worse in Christian relations with Jews, heretics, and other 'marginal' groups. As argued by R. I. Moore in his 1987 work *The Formation of a Persecuting Society*, it was during the eleventh and twelfth centuries that 'deliberately and socially sanctioned violence began to be directed, *through established governmental, judicial and social institutions*, against groups of people defined by general characteristics, such as race, religion, or way

of life; and that membership of such groups in itself came to be regarded as justifying these attacks'.² Persecution, in Moore's words, became 'habitual' and closely tied to the emergence of Christian Europe's new ruling elite, both ecclesiastical and secular. In the decades since the publication of this influential volume, numerous scholars have endorsed, expanded, refined, and criticized Moore's vision of the 'persecuting society', a label that now serves as a convenient shorthand for the broader question of how medieval Christians identified, marginalized, and sometimes violently oppressed the non-believers and non-orthodox in their midst.³

Joachim's vision of the future emphasized the harmonious conversion, rather than grudging assimilation or destruction of the Jews, leading a number of scholars to posit that his writings provide evidence of a countervailing sentiment that ran contrary to the persecuting mentality of the High Middle Ages. In this essay, I will survey recent scholarship on Joachim and the Jews in light of the 'persecuting society' thesis. The topic of apocalyptic conversion in the abbot's schemes, moreover, has not been limited exclusively to the Jews, since Joachim also raised the possibility that Muslims and other non-Christians would convert before the end of time. Some historians have begun to draw attention to the fact that Joachim also posited the eschatological conversion of heretical and schismatic Eastern Christians to the more spiritual faith of the Western, Roman Church. Looking beyond Joachim of Fiore, this emerging interest in the apocalyptic conversion of the Jews and other marginal groups has begun to widen to include other Christian exegetes and theologians, including the abbot's contemporaries and later Joachite thinkers influenced by him. Such recent scholarship forms a lively field of inquiry into medieval apocalypticism, promising further insights into some of the ways that Christian scenarios for the 'end of days' might complicate narratives of religious persecution, violence, and conversion.

Born in Calabria sometime around 1135, after a pilgrimage to the Holy Land and some profligate wandering, during his early 1130s Joachim settled into the monastic vocation at the Benedictine monastery of Corazzo, where he was elected abbot around 1176.⁴ Starting in 1183, he moved to the Cistercian house at Casamari for a 'sabbatical' of sorts, when he began to write his three major works: the *Book of Concordance of the New and Old Testament*,⁵ the *Exposition on the Apocalypse*,⁶ and the *Psaltery of Ten Chords*.⁷ Joachim had already penned several minor exegetical tracts on the meaning of history and coming of the apocalypse; he would continue to write and revise his principal compositions until his death in 1202, leaving unfinished a fourth major commentary, his *Tract on the Four Gospels*.⁸ In addition, either the abbot or some of his initial followers after his demise assembled the so-called *Book of Figures*, a compilation of diagrams, pictorial representations, and other images that illustrated some of his key historical and exegetical concepts.⁹

According to Joachim, a number of spiritual awakenings into the inner-meaning of Scripture inspired his literary output.¹⁰ Taking the Bible as his starting point, the abbot interpreted God's plan for history through the successive relationship of the Old and New Testaments, building upon the idea that the 'letter' of the Old Testament revealed hidden 'spiritual' meanings about the New Testament of Christ. In principle, of course, such Christian exegesis of the Bible was nothing new. In a highly innovative move, however, Joachim argued that the historical events recorded in the 'time of the Old Testament' provided a detailed set of coordinates for the course of events in the 'time of the New Testament'. View through this principal of 'concordance', all of history consisted of two time periods: the first, from Adam until the arrival of Christ, and the second, from Christ until the end of time. Important figures, wars, and other events that occurred in the time of the Old Testament directly corresponded to figures, wars, and

events in the time of the New Testament.¹¹ For example, based on the Book of Revelation, Joachim argued that the time of the Old Testament was divided into 'seven seals', each marked by an assault on the Jews. Likewise, the time of the New Testament was divided into seven seals, each one distinguished by a persecution of the Christian Church.¹² Joachim believed that he was living on the edge of the sixth seal, which would bring about two successive persecutions (the sixth and seventh, respectively), followed by the opening of the seventh seal. Deviating from Augustine of Hippo and other patristic authorities, Joachim viewed the subsequent, seventh age of history as just that – a part of history, not the eternal Sabbath that would follow Last Judgment.¹³

Complementing his division of time into two epochs, that of the Old and New Testaments, Joachim also developed a model of history divided into three eras (*status*): that of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit.¹⁴ The first *status* originated with Adam, came to fruition with Abraham, and ended with Christ. The second *status* began with King Uzziah of Judah, came to fruition with Zachary (the father of John the Baptist), and was drawing to a close in Joachim's own present. The third *status* had begun with Saint Benedict of Nursia, was coming to fruition around the abbot's own day, and would end with the consummation of history. This era of the Holy Spirit (corresponding to the seventh age of the New Testament) would form an age of peace and plenty, when a new order of 'spiritual men' would help to reform the Church and preach the Gospel everywhere. As Joachim described it, this Sabbath age would be 'without war, without scandal, without worry or terror, since God shall bless it and He shall sanctify it, because in it, He shall cease from all of his labor that He has accomplished'.¹⁵

Within this panorama of salvation history, Joachim confronted the problematic relationship between the Jews, the first claimants to God's favor, and the Christian Church, the inheritors of divine grace during the time of the New Testament. Among his minor works, the abbot devoted an entire tract, his *Exhortation to the Jews* (written during the 1190s) to the Jewish failure to recognize the Trinity and other Christian truths. Joachim wrote this piece, he declared, because he believed that 'the time of mercy' was close at hand for the Jews, 'a time of consolation and their conversion'.¹⁶ Throughout his writings, the abbot pursued and developed this important theme – that the Jews, written out of God's plan for history with the coming of Christ, would be restored to divine grace with transition to the final era of history, the coming Sabbath age of the Holy Spirit.

Modern scholars have long observed this relatively mild tone toward the Jews along with Joachim's emphasis on their conversion to the Christian faith as part of his eschatological scenarios.¹⁷ With his 2002 book *The Feast of Saint Abraham*, however, Robert Lerner signaled a heightened interest in precisely this question, responding directly to R. I. Moore's 'persecuting society' thesis.¹⁸ This was not the first time that Lerner, who has written a great deal on Joachim and other medieval apocalyptic thinkers, turned his attention toward the presentation of the Jews in Joachim's writings. In his tour-de-force 1976 article 'Refreshment of the Saints', Lerner examined the Christian belief that there would be a brief era of terrestrial rest and peace for the Church between the defeat of Antichrist and Final Judgment.¹⁹ Although this concept was not new, Joachim of Fiore greatly expanded upon this idea, offering a more vivid sense of what that earthly Sabbath would look like. In addition, Latin thinkers including Joachim clarified the long-standing Christian belief that the Jews, or at least a portion of them, would convert to Christianity during this earthly Sabbath after the defeat of Antichrist, following upon the heels of numerous pagan converts to the Church.²⁰ In his 1985 piece 'Antichrists and Antichrist', Lerner elucidated the role of the Antichrist in Joachim's scenarios (which envisioned multiple, lesser Antichrists throughout history), whose coming would signal the transition

to the final age of history. In particular, Lerner directed attention toward the fact that, contrary to long-standing Christian tradition, Joachim did not claim Antichrist would himself be a Jew and primarily served by Jews (hardly a flattering association); rather, the false Messiah would arise within the Western Church, mostly likely from among heretics, perhaps sitting on the papal see of Rome.²¹

In his book, Lerner devotes his full attention to the place of the Jews in Joachim's exegesis and eschatology, tracking this theme of Jewish conversion among subsequent apocalyptic thinkers who were more-or-less inspired by the abbot, including Peter John Olivi (d. 1298) and John of Rupescissa (d. 1362). According to Lerner, this millennialist 'vision of a world in which Jews and Gentiles would join as one flock' stood as theoretical alternative to the undeniable intensification of a Christian persecuting mentality during the High and Late Middle Ages.²² Re-opening a debate about whether Joachim was a Jewish convert to Christianity, Lerner leaves open the possibility that the abbot was born Jewish, but sees this question as ultimately inconsequential for the tenor of Joachim's attitude toward the Jews.²³ Rather, the abbot's emphasis on the Old Testament as a source of theological-historical authority – a key component of his 'total concordance' between the Old and New Testaments – entailed an unusually positive evaluation of the Hebrews and their scriptures. As part of his Trinitarian model of history, Joachim's association of the Jews with the *status* of the Father, followed by the Gentiles in the *status* of the Son, gave both peoples a key role in the progression of history, pointing toward the *status* of the Holy Spirit, when both Jews and Gentiles would enter together into a new, spiritual era.²⁴ Within Joachim's eschatological scenario, those penultimate Jews, of course, would come to recognize Christ and leave behind their 'carnal' understanding of the Bible: neither Joachim nor his successors were open to Jews persisting as Jews with a positive role to play in God's plan for the end of history. Nevertheless, in an age of dramatically worsening anti-Semitism, Lerner sees something important in this apocalyptic image of conversion. 'Granted that the Joachite millennialists were not tolerationists', he concludes, 'they nonetheless stood for an alternative to the formation of a persecuting society'.²⁵

Not long after the appearance of Lerner's book, two other scholars, Anna Sapir Abulafia and E. Randolph Daniel, directed their attention toward Joachim's ambivalent views of Judaism, setting them against the backdrop of a twelfth-century turn-for-the-worse in Christian-Jewish relations. In her 2003 essay 'The Conquest of Jerusalem', Abulafia places the abbot squarely into the age of crusading violence against Muslims and growing intolerance toward the Jews.²⁶ Although aware of Lerner's previous observations, she notes that the bulk of her research and writing on this subject occurred before the publication of his book.²⁷ Nevertheless, her interpretation of Joachim's millennialism leads her to make a similar argument that the abbot notionally swam against the rising tide of hostility toward the Jews and others. Drawing upon her expertise in twelfth-century Christian anti-Jewish polemics, Abulafia compares Joachim views in his *Exhortation to the Jews* with those of his 'scholastic' contemporaries, whose increasing emphasis on the priority of reason in matters of faith led them to portray the Jewish rejection of Christ as 'non-rational', making the Jews less than human.²⁸ Joachim also avoided a prolonged discussion of Christ's humanity and suffering on the Cross, suffering that other twelfth-century polemicists blamed collectively on the Jews.²⁹ The abbot, Abulafia argues, seemed to chart a different course with regard to the Jews and other sources of controversy in his contemporary world. 'Every aspect of Joachim's highly complex vision', she declares, 'challenged contemporary ideas about the efficacy of the crusades,

the roles of both pope and emperor in Christian society, the threat of Islam and also the position of the Jews of Christendom'.³⁰

A year later, E. R. Daniel published his essay 'Abbot Joachim of Fiore and the Conversion of the Jews'.³¹ Daniel is no stranger to questions of non-Christian conversion in Joachim's writings. In a 1969 article, he highlighted the abbot's ambivalence toward the crusades, if not the very premise of crusading as an act of armed violence against Muslims.³² According to Daniel, the liberation of Jerusalem by the crusaders did not fit with Joachim's prediction of horrible tribulations for the Western Church before the defeat of Antichrist and the start of the third *status*. For Joachim the crusades ran contrary to the will of God and were doomed to failure, although, by the same token, the abbot left room for the miraculous conversion of the Muslims in the apocalyptic future. In his 2004 essay, Daniel returns to Joachim's apocalyptic schemes, including his idea that the Jews would join with the Church during the coming era of the Holy Spirit. 'Joachim', he writes, 'dreamed of a future world in which both the Jewish and the Gentile peoples would flower as never before'. The abbot's view of the Jews, moreover,

stood in striking contrast to the prevailing trend in the last decades of the twelfth century. He did not focus on their role in the crucifixion, he did not demonize them and make them part of a devilish conspiracy against Christendom, he did not argue that they ought to be enserfed and treated harshly, and he certainly would have fought against massacres and forced conversions.³³

Daniel notes that Lerner's book appeared too late to be 'adequately treated' in his article; he does not seem to have been aware of Abulafia's essay.³⁴ Unlike Lerner, he comes down strongly on the side of Joachim being born a Christian, rather than a Jewish convert, claiming that Joachim's putative Jewish roots would have surely occasioned far more (negative) attention among contemporaries.³⁵ Basing his criticisms on Lerner's earlier works, including his article 'Antichrist and Antichrists', Daniel expresses strong disagreement with Lerner's model of the third *status* as a 'post-antichrist final period of rest', based on earlier patristic notions that there would be a brief time of 'refreshment' for the Church before the imminent end of time. In this model, Daniel declares, the third *status* must come after the 'final antichrist' and 'will not last very long'. He continues that 'Lerner has not explained how this thesis would affect Joachim's expectation of the conversion of the Jews'.³⁶ Daniel, by contrast, argues that the abbot relegated Final Judgment the distant future, leaving a far greater span of time for the reform of the Church during the seventh, final era of history that would also form the *status* of the Holy Spirit.³⁷ Presumably, Daniel's scheme would leave more time for the conversion of the Jews, not to mention Muslims and other Gentiles.

In fairness to Lerner, he does not suggest that Joachim believed the third *status* would come after the *final* Antichrist; rather, he argues that the abbot believed it would begin after the tribulations under the 'great' Antichrist, the long-anticipated anti-messiah of the Christian tradition, meaning that there would be yet another, final Antichrist at the end of the third *status* just before Final Judgment. Regardless of the details, this disagreement over Joachim's time-table for the coming of the third *status* is intriguing and, in a sense, should not be surprising. Joachim could be inconsistent and deliberately vague about his predictions for the imminent future (he claimed, e.g., that there were only two generations left until the end of the present age of history, but would not specify how many years each generation would last). At points, he seems to imply that the new era of the Holy Spirit would start in the year 1260 and would be brief; at others, his predictions of marvelous, future transformations seem to necessitate a much longer period of transition

and spiritual fruition before the end of time. This being the case, a certain lack of clarity about the abbot's predictions for the conversion the Jews, Greeks, and other peoples seems less than surprising.

Clearly, the final word has yet to be said in modern scholarship on Joachim's millennial vision of Jewish conversion, not to mention the broader implications of Christian apocalypticism for the prevailing narrative of the twelfth century as a time of growing Christian antagonism toward non-Christians and non-orthodox groups. As noted above, Lerner's book traces millennialist attitudes toward Jews down into the fifteenth century, but leaves ample room for further discussion about the place of religious 'outsiders' in the works of such important 'Joachite' thinkers as Peter John Olivi and John of Rupescissa. Looking in the other direction, scholars have begun to examine other apocalyptic exegetes who preceded Joachim, asking similar questions about their implications for the 'persecuting society'. For example, in his 2004 article '*Synagoga conversa*', Jeremy Cohen locates a similar emphasis on the harmonious apocalyptic union of Jews and Gentiles in the struggle against Antichrist found in Honorius Augustodunensis' commentary on the Songs of Songs, written during the early twelfth century.³⁸ Cohn argues that this scenario places Honorius outside the general trajectory of a growing anti-Semitism during the period. 'Let there be no mistake', he qualifies, 'Honorius offers no anachronistically ecumenical blueprint for religious pluralism at the end of days; the only Jews to be saved will be baptized Jews'.³⁹ Nevertheless, Cohen sees signs in Honorius' exegesis – composed before the writings of Joachim – that Christian apocalyptic thinkers could re-imagine the relationship between Jews and Christians in less severe tones than one might expect.⁴⁰

The significance of apocalyptic conversion for Christendom's attitudes toward the Islamic world also awaits further attention. In his 2007 book *L'Islam et la fin des temps*, Jean Flori has re-opened the topic of Joachim's ambivalent attitude toward the crusades, revisiting Daniel's earlier observations about the implicit criticisms of crusading found in the abbot's writings.⁴¹ Flori's treatment of the Calabrian abbot forms one small piece of his wider look at how Christians interpreted the apocalyptic significance of Islam from the seventh century to the end of the Middle Ages. In recent years, two scholars, Brett Whalen and Felicitas Schmieder, have raised the related question of how Joachim grappled with the relationship between the Western, Latin Church, and the Greek, Eastern Church. In his 2003 piece 'Joachim of Fiore and the Division of Christendom', again responding directly to *The Feast of Saint Abraham*, Whalen explores the abbot's argument that God's favor followed a trajectory not just from Jews to Gentiles, but more specifically, from the Jews to the Greek Church, and from the Greeks to the Latin Church, when the Greeks lost their place in the divine plan due to their heretical tendencies and rejection of papal authority. In the future era of the Holy Spirit, however, the spiritual men of the Latin Church would first restore the Greeks to God's grace, before ushering in the conversion of the Jews.⁴² In her 2006 essay 'Two Unequal Brothers Split and Reunited', Schmieder addresses some similar points about the abbot's treatment of Greek Church, tracking his ideas among 'Joachite' thinkers in the thirteenth century.⁴³ Most recently, in his 2009 book *Dominion of God*, Whalen returns the question of 'apocalyptic conversion' in its widest sense, exploring how theologians of history before and after Joachim of Fiore imagined the creation of a 'single fold' under 'one shepherd', meaning for contemporaries the world-wide expansion of Latin Christianity during the High Middle Ages.⁴⁴

If these recent works are any indicator, scholars show few signs of losing interest in medieval apocalyptic scenarios and what they might tell us about the broader

development of European intellectual life and culture, including the so-called 'formation of a persecuting society'. What seems to be emerging represents both a challenge to Moore's captivating thesis, but one that ultimately reinforces the wider claim – highlighted by Moore, but certainly not unique to his work – that the 'long' twelfth century formed a crucial era in the development of Christian European attitudes toward Jews, heretics, Muslims, and even other kinds of Christians from outside the Roman Church.⁴⁵ Whether taking a hard-line stance against God's perceived enemies, or speculating about their eventual conversion, the Latin clerical and monastic elite of a 'maturing' Western Christian civilization found themselves increasingly occupied with the question of what to do with – and what would eventually happen to – those who refused to shed their erroneous beliefs and ways of life, thereby paradoxically endangering and affirming the superior nature of the orthodox Christian community. As to the related question of whether such medieval persecutors and millennial dreamers tell us something about modern Western society and its own preoccupations with threats and deviance, readers must decide for themselves.

Short Biography

Brett Whalen, assistant professor of history at the University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill, works on Christian intellectual and cultural history during the High Middle Ages. His first monograph, *Dominion of God: Christendom and Apocalypse in the Middle Ages*, appeared in October 2009 with Harvard University Press. He recently published an article titled 'Rethinking the Schism of 1054: Authority, Heresy, and the Latin Rite', *Traditio*, 62 (2007): 1–24. In addition, he has several forthcoming essays, including a piece on Joachim of Fiore in *A Companion to Joachim of Fiore* (Brill), along with an essay on crusader Bohemond of Taranto's campaign against the Byzantine Empire (ca. 1107), appearing in *The Crusades: Medieval Worlds in Conflict* (Ashgate).

Notes

* Correspondence: University of North Carolina, CB 3195, Chapel Hill, NC 27599, USA. Email: bwhalen@email.unc.edu.

¹ Dated, but still useful surveys of scholarship on Joachim include G. La Piana, 'Joachim of Flora: A Critical Survey', *Speculum*, 7 (1932): 257–82; and M. Bloomfield, 'Joachim of Fiore: A Critical Survey of His Canon, Teachings, Sources, Biography and Influence', *Traditio*, 13 (1957): 249–311. See also M. Bloomfield, 'Recent Scholarship on Joachim of Fiore and His Influence', in A. Williams (ed.), *Prophecy and Millenarianism: Essays in Honour of Marjorie Reeves*, (Harlow, UK: Longman, 1980), 21–52; and E. R. Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore: New Editions and Studies', *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 21 (2000): 675–85. See also H. Grundmann, *Studien Über Joachim Von Fiore* (1927; Darmstadt: Wissenschaftliche Buchgesellschaft, 1966); M. Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages* (1969; Notre Dame, 1993); and M. Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore and the Prophetic Future* (1976; Stroud, UK: Sutton Publishing, 1999).

² R. I. Moore, *The Formation of a Persecuting Society: Authority and Deviance in Western Europe, 950–1250*, rev. ed. (1987; Malden, MA: Blackwell, 2007), 4 (original emphasis).

³ See P. Freedman and G. Spiegel, 'Medievalism Old and New: The Rediscovery of Alterity in North American Medieval Studies', *American Historical Review*, 103 (1998): 677–704.

⁴ For two near contemporary *vitae* of the abbot, see H. Grundmann, 'Zur Biographie Joachims von Fiore und Raniers von Ponza', *Deutsches Archiv für Erforschung des Mittelalters*, 16 (1960): 437–546; see also B. McGinn, *The Calabrian Abbot: Joachim of Fiore in the History of Western Thought* (New York: Macmillan Publishing Company, 1985), 18–30.

⁵ For the first four books of the *Book of Concordance*, see Joachim of Fiore, 'Joachim of Fiore: Liber de concordia novi et veteris testamenti', E. R. Daniel (ed.), *American Philosophy Society*, 73 (Philadelphia: American Philosophical Society, 1983). for book five, see Joachim of Fiore, *Concordia novi et veteris testamenti* (1519; Frankfurt: Minerva, 1964).

- ⁶ There is no still critical edition of Joachim of Fiore, *Expositio in Apocalypsim* (1527; Frankfurt: Minerva, 1964), although one is planned as part of the 'Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore' series under the direction of K.-V. Selge. The abbot's introduction to the *Expositio* has already been published: see Joachim of Fiore, 'Introduzione all'Apocalisse', Selge (ed.) and G. L. Potesta' (trans.), *Opera di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti* 6 (Rome: Viella, 1995).
- ⁷ A critical edition of the *Psalterium* has just appeared: see Joachim of Fiore, 'Psalterium decem cordarum', in K.-V. Selge (ed.), *Monumenta Germaniae Historica: Quellen zur Geistgeschichte des Mittelalters*, 20 (Hannover: Hahnsche Buchhandlung, 2009).
- ⁸ Joachim of Fiore, 'Tractatus super quatuor evangelia', F. Santi (ed.), *Fonti per la storia dell'Italia medievale: antiquitates*, 17 (Rome: Istituto storico italiano per il Medio Evo, 2002).
- ⁹ For an edition of the *Liber figurarum*, see L. Tondelli, *Il libro delle figure dell'abate Gioacchino da Fiore* (Turin: Società editrice internazionale, 1953); many of the principle images from the Tondelli edition are available online at: http://www.centrostudiogioachimite.it/Gioacchino/GF_Tavoleeng.asp (accessed on 20 Sept, 2009). On Joachim's *Liber figurarum*, see also Rainini, M., 'Disegni dei tempi: il "Liber Figurarum" e la teologia figurative di Gioacchino da Fiore', *Opera di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti*, 18 (Rome: Viella, 2006).
- ¹⁰ See R. Lerner, 'Joachim of Fiore's Breakthrough to Chiliasm', *Cristianesimo nella storia*, 6 (1985): 489–512; and R. Lerner, 'Ecstatic Dissent', *Speculum*, 67 (1992): 33–57.
- ¹¹ In addition to M. Reeves, *Joachim of Fiore*, 1–28; see E. R. Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore: Patterns of History in the Apocalypse', in R. K. Emmerson and B. McGinn (eds.), *The Apocalypse in the Middle Ages*, (Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 1992), 72–88; and E. R. Daniel, 'A New Understanding of Joachim: The Concords, the Exile, and the Exodus', in R. Rusconi (ed.), *Gioacchino da Fiore tra Bernardo di Clairvaux e Innocenzo III*, *Opere di Gioacchino da Fiore: testi e strumenti*, 13 vols. (Rome: Viella, 2001), 209–22.
- ¹² See J. E. Wannenmacher, *Hermeneutik der Heilsgeschichte: De septem sigillis und die sieben Siegel im Werk Joachims von Fiore*, *Studies in the History of Christian Traditions*, 118 vols. (Leiden: Brill, 2005).
- ¹³ See R. Lerner, 'The Medieval Return to the Thousand-Year Sabbath', in R. Emmerson and B. McGinn (eds.), *The Apocalypse in the Middle Ages*, (Ithaca: University of Cornell Press, 1992), 51–71.
- ¹⁴ See M. Reeves, *Influence of Prophecy* (1969; Notre Dame, 1993), 16–27, 126–32.
- ¹⁵ *Liber de concordia*, bk. 5, fol. 133ra.
- ¹⁶ Joachim of Fiore, 'Exhortatorium Iudeorum', A. Patschovsky (ed.), *Fonti per la storia dell'Italia medievale: antiquitates*, 26 (Rome: Nella sede dell'istituto Palazzo Borromini, 2006).
- ¹⁷ See B. Hirsch-Reich, 'Joachim von Fiore und das Judentum', in P. Wilpert (ed.), *Judentum im Mittelalter: Beiträge zum christlich-jüdischen Gespräch*, (Berlin: de Gruyter, 1966), 228–63.
- ¹⁸ See R. Lerner, *The Feast of Saint Abraham: Medieval Millenarians and the Jews* (Philadelphia: University of Philadelphia Press, 2002).
- ¹⁹ R. Lerner, 'Refreshment of the Saints: The Time after Antichrist as a Station for Earthly Progress in Medieval Thought', *Traditio*, 32 (1976): 97–144.
- ²⁰ Lerner, 'Refreshment of the Saints', 110–19.
- ²¹ R. Lerner, 'Antichrists and Antichrist in Joachim of Fiore', *Speculum*, 60 (1985): 553–70; see especially pp. 566–68.
- ²² Lerner, *Feast of Saint Abraham*, 1.
- ²³ Lerner, *Feast of Saint Abraham*, 24–29, diverges in this regard from Hirsch-Reich, 'Joachim von Fiore und das Judentum', 239–43.
- ²⁴ Lerner, *Feast of Saint Abraham*, 29–37.
- ²⁵ Lerner, *Feast of Saint Abraham*, 121.
- ²⁶ A. S. Abulafia, 'The Conquest of Jerusalem: Joachim of Fiore and the Jews', in M. Bull and N. Housely (eds.), *The Experience of Crusading*, (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2003), 127–46.
- ²⁷ See Abulafia, 'The Conquest of Jerusalem', 128, 129 n. 5.
- ²⁸ Among her other works, see A. S. Abulafia, *Christians and Jews in the Twelfth-Century Renaissance* (London: Routledge, 1995).
- ²⁹ Abulafia, 'Conquest of Jerusalem', 129–46.
- ³⁰ Abulafia, 'Conquest of Jerusalem', 127.
- ³¹ E. R. Daniel, 'Abbot Joachim of Fiore and the Conversion of the Jews', in S. McMichael and S. Myers (eds.), *Friars and Jews in the Middle Ages and Renaissance*, *The Medieval Franciscans*, 2 vols. (Leiden: Brill, 2004), 1–22.
- ³² E. R. Daniel, 'Apocalyptic Conversion: The Joachite Alternative to Crusade', *Traditio*, 25 (1969): 127–54. Abulafia, 'Conquest of Jerusalem', 127, n. 1, cites this article in the opening of her essay, but does not pursue the topic of apocalyptic Islamic conversion.
- ³³ Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore', 20, 21.
- ³⁴ Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore', 12, n. 49.
- ³⁵ Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore', 5.
- ³⁶ Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore', 12.
- ³⁷ Daniel, 'Joachim of Fiore', 7. See E. R. Daniel, 'Abbot Joachim of Fiore: A Reformist Apocalyptic', in C. Kleinhenz and F. LeMoine (eds.), *Fearful Hope: Approaching the New Millenium*, (Madison: University of Wisconsin Press, 1999), 207–10.

- ³⁸ J. Cohen, 'Synagoga conversa: Honorius Augustodunensis, the Song of Songs, and Christianity's "Eschatological Jew"', *Speculum*, 79 (2004): 309–40; in particular, on Lerner's treatment of Joachim, see pp. 332–34.
- ³⁹ Cohen, 'Synagoga conversa', 325.
- ⁴⁰ Cohen, 'Synagoga conversa', 332, praises Lerner's 'fascinating monograph', but also suggests that his 'attribution of novelty to the role of the Jews in Joachim's eschatology bears reconsideration'.
- ⁴¹ J. Flori, *L'Islam et la fin des temps: l'interprétation prophétique des invasions musulmanes dans la chrétienté médiévale* (Paris: Éditions du Seuil, 2007), 317–26.
- ⁴² B. Whalen, 'Joachim of Fiore and the Division of Christendom', *Viator*, 98 (2003): 89–108.
- ⁴³ F. Schmieder, 'Two Unequal Brothers Split and Reunited – the Greeks in Latin Eschatological Perceptions of Politics and History before and after 1204', in G. Ortalli et al. (eds.), *Quarta crociata: Venezia – Bisanzio – impero Latino* (Venice: Istituto veneto di scienze, lettere, ed arti, 2006), 633–51.
- ⁴⁴ B. Whalen, *Dominion of God: Christendom and Apocalypse in the Middle Ages* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 2009).
- ⁴⁵ In the revised, expanded edition of *The Formation of a Persecuting Society*, 172–96, Moore responds to the debates that have surrounded his book, including (pp. 179–80) some brief comments on Lerner's work *The Feast of Saint Abraham*. As Moore observes, 'Such histories will cast much light on the formation of the persecuting society. They are unlikely to suggest that it was uniform, inevitable, or independent of contingency'.

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